5.1.4 Owning or renting a house

In general, many families feel that owning a house is far better than renting.

Owning: This is buying a house outright in order to secure it services.		**Renting:** Rent is the compensation that is paid to the owner, generally in terms of money, by the user for the services of a house, from month to month.
Advantages of Owning		**Advantages of Renting**
1	People who own a house will feel secure and have a feeling of belongingness.	Renting is cheaper.
2	Can develop long standing friendship with neighbours.	Can change the house according to the needs and income of the family.
3	Become a means of compulsory saving.	Money spent on buying the house can be invested in other business to get more money returns.
4	Can stay in a house for a long period.	No responsibility of maintaining the property.
5	Changes or improvement in the house can be made whenever needed.	Freedom of mobility.
6	Gives a feeling of happiness, pride and sense of security during old age.	Higher living standards can be achieved
7	Credit can be acquired easily.	Can take advantage of different occupational opportunities.
8	It is a good investment.	Gives financial freedom.
9	Have tax benefits.	The family will not get affected if the property value decreases.
10	Better furniture and furnishing can be purchased.	No need to invest on furnishings and furniture as furnished house can be rented.

5.2 Site Selection

Each family attempts to meet its housing needs through the selection of a suitable dwelling unit. The house is undoubtedly the largest single investment you will make in your life. One cannot change one's residence often. Hence it becomes essential for each one of us to have adequate knowledge about selection of a site and house planning. A site in a good locality should be selected.

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